

Beex

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Class: ICB2A

International Creative Business - Hogeschool Inholland, Haarlem

International Boardroom - UoS1 - Organization report

Lecturers: Koster, Wouter; Sugarman, Ken

Submission: 31-11-2022 (resit)

Table of Contents

1. Introduction.....	1
1.1. Summary of Assignment	1
1.2. Research Question	1
1.3. Mission and vision	2
2. Beex Company Analysis.....	3
2.1. Internal Analysis	3
2.1.1.	
People, resources, structure	3
2.1.2.	
The marketing mix	5
2.1.3.	
PMC.....	5
2.1.4.	
Legal aspects	5
2.1.5.	
Financial core data.....	6
2.1.6.	
Corporate social responsibility	7
2.2. External analysis	7
2.2.1.	
Macro environment	7
2.2.2.	
Competition	8
2.2.3.	
Target group	8
3. Organizational report	9
3.1. SWOT analysis	9
3.2. Conclusion	10
4. Bibliography	12
5. Appendices.....	19

1. Introduction

The team



The Xport team is a company that will assist you in bringing your business abroad by studying the current market and the best option for your company! Five members are here to assist you, Jessica Redondo Müller (Research manager), Angeline Chatelain (Legal manager), Karla Ostojić (Marketing manager), Merel Zwart (General manager), and Omar Abdulghani (Finance manager). All studying International Creative Business, our expertise in the current market and experience coming from different countries. We will help you and your company to adapt to a new culture and environment by bringing your own and sharing it with the world.

Our client

Beex is a full-service marketing and branding agency located in Amsterdam. Their team of nine women offers their service of graphic design, content creation, public relations, digital marketing, social media, branding, advertising, copyright, packaging design strategy, and influence marketing (Beex, n.d-b).

1.1. Summary of Assignment

This organizational report will give a complete overview of Beex as a company. By analyzing Beex internally, as well as shedding light on external factors influencing them, a complete picture will be drawn up of Beex's Strengths, Weaknesses as well as some of their opportunities and threats. Subsequently, this report's conclusion will build the base for Beex's export plan.

1.2. Research Question

To be able to properly create an aim and define what needs to happen in the research a research objective has been created (Verhoeven, 2019).

The objective of the research is to gain insight into the strengths and weaknesses of the company, as well as find opportunities and threats in relation to the external environment. By analyzing and drawing up a complete picture of the company, the basis for the following financial and export plan for Beex will be set up. "Framing an appropriate research question is the most critical and fundamental part of a study" (Dhir & Gupta, 2021). Therefore, the following research questions and sub-questions have been formulated:

Research Question:

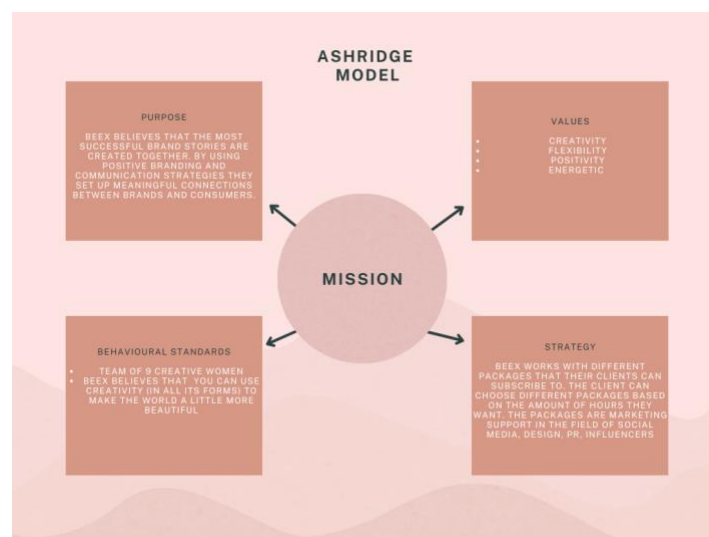
What defines BEEEX's current internal organization and its external market position, including the company's strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats in the year 2022 with a retrospective on the year 2021?

Sub-Questions:

- What are BEEEX's mission and vision, in accordance with the Ashbridge model, in the year 2022?
- How is BEEEX's business organized, including people, resources, and structure in the year 2022?
- What is BEEEX's marketing strategy, in accordance with the 5P's model, in 2022?
- What is BEEEX's Product Market Combination, in accordance with the STP model in the year 2022?
- What are BEEEX's legal aspects based on the legal rights in The Netherlands in the year 2022?
- What is BEEEX's financial core data, including profit development, turnover development, and cost development from 2021 to 2022?
- What entails BEEEX's CSR strategy, in accordance with the 3P Model and the 17 sustainability goals of the UN, in the year 2022?
- Where is Beex's position concerning external environmental impacts on the company, including their macro environment and competition, in accordance with the PESTLE analysis and the Porters 5 forces model, in the year 2022?
- What defines BEEEX's target group, using the four types of segmentation, including demographic, psychographic, geographic, and behavioral properties, in the year 2022?

1.3.Mission and vision

Based on the Ashridge model (Ashridge-model, 2019), the following aspects of Beex's mission could have been analyzed. An additional explanation can be found in Appendix 1.



The mission of Beex is: by using positive branding and communication strategies we set up meaningful connections between brands and consumers. And their vision is: because we believe that you can use creativity (in all its forms) to make the world a little more

beautiful. To achieve this vision Beex is currently building a team and working with clients with which their vision resonates. The results they have been seeing from these actions so far are that they haven't done any acquisition in the past 7 years. Clients come in via and staff comes in via an internship (Personal communication client, 2022).

2. Beex Company Analysis

2.1. Internal Analysis

2.1.1. People, resources, structure

Based on the McKinsey 7S Model (see appendix 2) and the client's briefing the internal structure of Beex, management style, and organization culture, will be described in the following part.

Structure

Beex is a full-service marketing and PR agency. This means you can hire them to take care of your social media, public relations, branding and design, content, and digital marketing. They focus 80% on the BTC (Business To Customer) market and 20% on the BTB (Business To Business) market. Beex consists of a team of nine women who are all specialized in different areas like design & brand strategy and media & content (Client brief, 2022). Beex was found in 2015 by Bieke van Orten. The team consists of 9 creative women, and they are all specialized in a different area. The staff consists of the following roles: founder, head of design & brand strategy, junior creative, design intern, head of media & content, social media, content & PR managers, Media, content & PR intern + Freelancers + other agencies photographers, videographers, copywriters, online marketers, UX designers, web developers, etc (Onze Creatievelingen, 2022). Beex helps their clients with single things like shoots or design & branding. But besides that, they also offer different packages to their clients. These packages are monthly subscriptions and are marketing support in the field of social media, design, PR, and influencers (Client brief, 2022).

Management styles

As already mentioned above, the Beex team consists of 9 employees, including CEO Bieke. Each employee is specialized in their own area and together they create the best product for their clients. According to Bieke, she is the one that makes the final decisions in most projects: "I don't operate in the projects but make the final decision in almost every project, especially when it comes to budgets/proposals/contracts etc." But each member of the Beex team does have its own contact at the brands they work for. They meet with them on a weekly, bi-weekly, or monthly basis, which means the employees of Beex are all valued and play a big part in the whole process (Personal communication client, 2022).

When looking at different management styles mentioned on the Valamis website the one that fits best Beex is the Participative management style. In this management style, the managers and the staff are all active members of the decision process. A pro about this management style is that employees feel as though they are valued by their management team and the organization as a whole and will respond with increased motivation and productivity. However, a con can also be that there is a risk of staff with bigger personalities overpowering less assertive staff

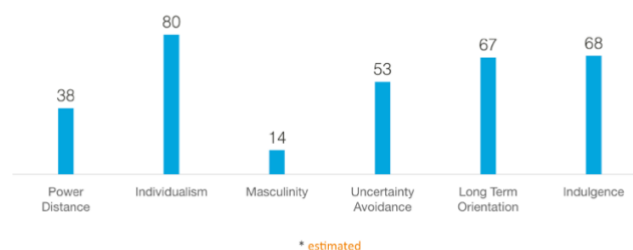
members, leading to conflicts and resentment (10 Types of Management Styles: Which One Is the Best [2022], 2022). In the visualized chart you can see the team distribution within the Beex company.



Organization structure

According to Chandan Gosh, a successful organization needs to have four elements. inspiring leadership: if there is no leader that inspires the members of the organization, success will not be achieved. A dynamic organization: successful leaders always focus on building a strong, dynamic, and empowered organization. Because they are self-confident and don't suffer from insecurities, they can build a strong network of brilliant people with varied skills and experience around them who can work independently. Impactful strategies: when the leadership team is in place it focuses on building great strategies that help the organization to achieve its objectives, both short and long-term. For any organization strategies are not static, it's always dynamic. Transparent and consistent communication: Communication plays a very important role in all organizations, both internal and external. If an organization doesn't communicate to its own people transparently and consistently it can never build a motivated and dedicated team. If the team is not motivated and dedicated 100% it is impossible to win on the battlefield. So, every organization must find a way to communicate transparently to its people (Ghosh, 2020).

To gain a better understanding of Beex's organizational structure it is interesting to analyze the results of the Hofstede Model based in the Netherlands (see definition of the Hofstede model in Appendix 3). Because the whole Beex team is Dutch and based in the Netherlands they are directly confronted with the Dutch culture.



(Hofstede Insights, 2017)

2.1.2. The marketing mix

To be able to define Beex's marketing strategy, the 5Ps of the Marketing Model (Corporate Finance Institute, 2022) can be utilized to position the company within the market. Further explanation of the model, as well as the application of the model to the clients business, can be found in Appendix 4.



(Beex 5 P's, see Appendix 4)

2.1.3. PMC

The Kotler's STP model has been used to analyze whether the company BEEEX has a solid product-market combination. The segmentation step, which determines the communication within the organization and may aid in differentiating it from the competitors, is the first of three processes in this approach. The second step entails focusing on a certain business division. The final step is brand positioning, which refers to the company's appeal and the impression it gives customers. See Appendix 11 to see the procedure used to determine BEEEX's PMC.

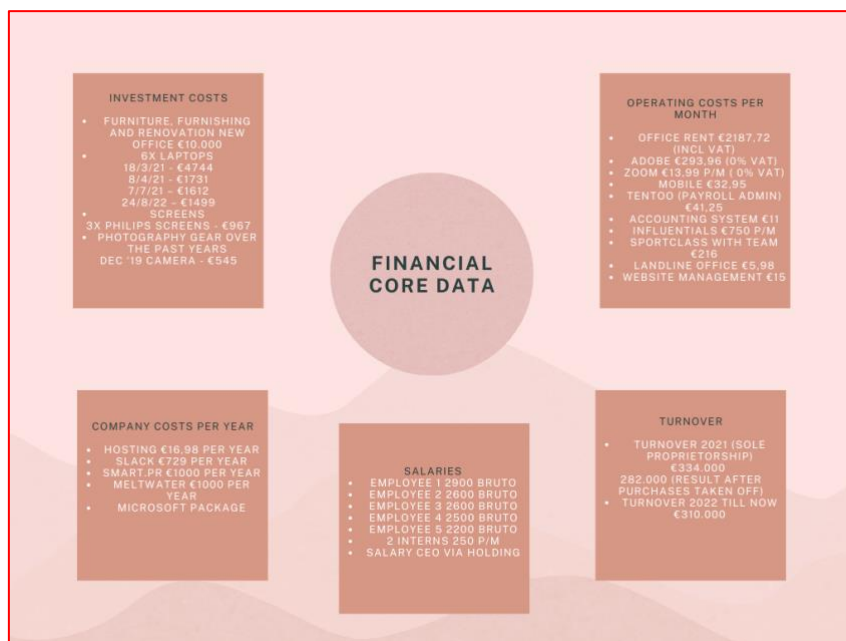
By using this STP model, it was demonstrated that the BEEEX company meets all criteria for a good product-market combination. They are founded on customer trust and communication. They provide one-of-a-kind services to a specific group of customers, implying that the brand focuses on lifestyle, food, and fashion.

2.1.4. Legal aspects

In order to present the different legal aspects of the BEEEX company, the steps outlined in Writer (n.d.)'s article were followed. BEEEX is a private limited company in Amsterdam and therefore has to follow important aspects such as the licenses, NDA, trademark, GPDR, IP or even contracting aspects. All of those aspects are presented in Appendix 12.

2.1.5. Financial core data

Here the financial core data from Beex will be discussed. In 2020 Beex made a turnover from €236.007 and in 2021 €334.099. This means there's a €98.092 difference in the turnover from the past 2 years. Comparing this to the costs which were €93.652 in 2020 and €197.081 in 2021. Beex made a profit of €142.355 in 2020 and €137.018 in 2021. But as Beex still counts as a sole proprietorship the private withdrawals from the CEO also have to be taken off the profit. In 2020 there was a private deposit from €4.380 and a withdrawal from €37.102. This means the end profit in 2020 was €109.633 In 2021 there was a private deposit from €1192 and a withdrawal from €39.099 which means the end profit in 2021 was €99.111. This was influenced by multiple factors. A few of these are a higher purchase value of sales, more wages and salaries, higher housing costs and costs of sales (Jaarrekening Beex, 2021).



(BEEEX Jaarrekening Report, 2022)

The turnover from Beex is divided by subscriptions & individual products. Individual products are shoots / design & branding. Subscriptions is marketing support in the field of social media, design, PR, influencers

Beex works with the following packages for this:

Package 10 hours p/m = € 850 € 85 p/h

Package 20 hours p/m = €1600 €80 p/h

Package 30 hours p/m = €2325 €77.50 p/h

Package 40 hours p/m = €3000 €75 p/h ·

Packages of 40 hours or more go at the reduced hourly rate of €75.

2.1.6. Corporate social responsibility

Today's goals are not solely about making money, but also about the environmental impact a business has on our planet. Thus, integrating a CSR (Cooperate Social Responsibility) strategy into a business is something that can make the difference and separate Beex from its competitors. As for right now, Beex does not incorporate CSR in its website or the overall marketing of its agency. Still, the CEO mentions that they are slowly trying to focus more on this matter, specifically working with more sustainable clients and therefore showing CSR through their portfolio (Client Brief, 2022).

And although this is important, there are many more ways to start actively prioritizing CSR to fulfill eg. the People, Profit, Planet Model and achieve a fully sustainable business. “No simple techniques exist to help companies make the necessary choices which range from identifying and defining new CSR challenges to best fit the company to coordinating various initiatives and building up support for their implementation” (Jonker & Witte, 2006). To find said CSR challenges, the 17 UN goals of sustainable development (see explanation and possible improvements Beex could implement in Appendix 5) can be used to determine externalities and therefore, possible actions to take in order to offset Beex’s negative impacts (CSR lecture, 2022).



(Mixon, 2021)

2.2.External analysis

2.2.1. Macro environment

The external analysis examines the external environment and sheds light on the environment of Beex. Together with the internal analysis, it provides the input for a SWOT analysis, which will be covered later in this report. The PESTLE model helps to comprehend the larger business environment in terms of Political, Economic, Sociological, Technological, Legal, and Environmental factors (CIPD, 2021). To learn more about the analysis of the model and its components in depth see appendix 6.

2.2.2. Competition



The competitors chosen for this analysis are DEPT and VOXX. A deeper analysis can be found in the Appendices (see appendix 7).

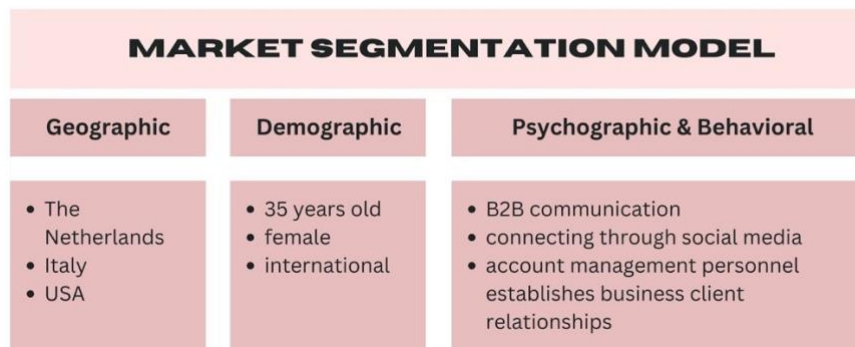


2.2.3. Target group

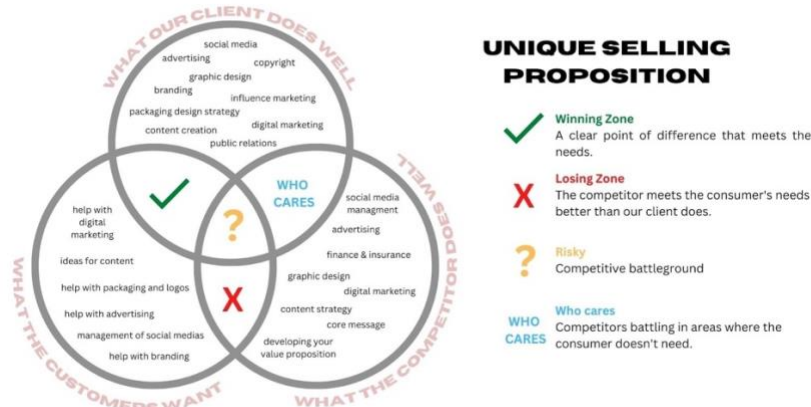
Beex is a marketing and branding agency which means that their target audiences are lifestyle companies with investors. (Personal communication - client, 2022). What is a lifestyle company? A lifestyle company/business is typically owned and operated by its founders. These companies aim to provide products or services that improve the lifestyle of their market's consumers. Lifestyle businesses can sometimes emerge from founders looking for a way to make money doing things they enjoy, such as hobbies. In general, a lifestyle company focuses on selling a service that they enjoy or are passionate about (Lifestyle Company: Definition and Examples (2022), n.d.).

Now, why is it important to have investors as a company? An investor is any person or other entity who invests money with the expectation of profit (What Does an Investor Do?, 2022). There are various types of investors, such as mutual funds, hedge funds, venture capital, angel investors, and so on. These investors can undoubtedly assist startups in raising capital for their ventures. Startups can also raise capital from other sources, such as shareholders'

funds (equity and preference), long-term borrowing, debentures, current liabilities, public funds, bank loans, and so on (Why Investors Play an Important Role in a Startup, 2019). To understand the target group better a Market Segmentation Model was used:



A Unique selling Proposition Diagram was used to describe why the product and/or service is purchased by the customers:



(Tan, 2021)

3. Organizational report

3.1.SWOT analysis

After analyzing Beex's company from within, as well as taking a look at the external forces playing into their success, certain strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats have come up to the surface. **For more detailed information on each component of the SWOT analysis see appendix 8.**

S.

Strengths

Starting with strengths, Beex is a so called **“full-service agency”** **and offers adaptable flexibility** in today fast paced time (see 2.1.2). Adding to this, Beex is a small **“boutique”, creative and young, women-only team, which are attributes and strengths** that let clients have an **intimate, personalized, accepting, and fun work environment** while receiving **high-quality results** (see 2.1.2 & 2.1.3). **Their diverse work and wide variety of knowledge and experience from their team members (see 2.1.3), serve as a great advantage (see 2.1.2).** In Beex's case, the internal analysis shows that they have a

good product-market-combination (see 2.1.3). Finally, one of Beex's areas of expertise is social media, a field that is still consistently **growing** (see PESTLE analysis results) and therefore provides a relatively safe future for their social media project-based clients (see 2.2.1).

W.

Weaknesses

Regardless, the analysis also brought up some potential weaknesses, including the **missing CSR** components (see 2.1.6). Another small but still mentionable weakness could pose the participative **management style**, **which could lead to internal team disagreements** (see 2.1.1). An additional weakness was found in Beex's missing marketing for their business (see 2.1.2). Finally, as seen in 2.1.4 Legal aspects, Beex has little to no legal protection. This could become more and more dangerous as the company grows bigger and could potentially create issues in the future.

O.

Opportunities

Beex has a variety of opportunities, including improving how customers perceive Beex as a brand; better marketing the company; standing out from Beex's competitors; creating and maintaining its reputation as a brand; increasing sales; staying relevant to Beex's customers and industry; working with more clients abroad; expanding Beex's international prospects and possible future collaborations; developing in the domain of corporate social responsibility; expanding Beex's networks and connections abroad; and finding additional source(s) of revenue.

T.

Threats

Among the threats that BEEEX can encounter are competition, such as DEPT and VOXX, and technological changes due to automation and increased competition, furthermore, it is possible that a third party will register the same or a similar trademark as BEEEX since they are not a registered trademark.

3.2. Conclusion

After analyzing BEEEX's internal and external environment in 2021, through answering each of the set sub-questions, the company's strengths, weaknesses, opportunities and threats in the year 2022 have been found (see Appendix 10 for detailed account of each of the sub-questions and their fitting paragraphs).

BEEEX has many important strengths, like their flexible subscription-based business model, their small, young, women only team with diverse knowledge and experience, as well as their market being one that is consistently growing.

Still, some weaknesses like a missing CSR strategy, their management style or the little legal protection have been found.

As for BEEEX's opportunities, many openings could be found, including but not limited to more marketing for the company, more cooperations with international clients, CSR incorporation and additional sources of revenue.

Finally, some threats like increased competition, technological changes or legal threats have been brought to attention.

To conclude, a detailed account of all of the company's aspects has been drawn up, which shows the potential of exporting BEEX to a new country and will set the starting point for the following export plan.

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5. Appendices

Appendix 1

Mission and vision:

The Ashbridge mission model was developed by Andrew Campbell. He focuses on the mission of an organization. Campbell argues that a well-formulated mission statement ensures that an organization can direct its operations, determine its goals, provide guidance on daily procedures, and describe policies. The Ashridge mission model provides guidance when drawing up this mission by paying attention to both strategic and cultural aspects. The strategic aspect can be seen as the first step in the strategic management process, in which the cultural part ensures good cooperation between the employees.

Merging these two creates a new view on the term mission. The mission is a short summary that reflects the essence of a company. This is why it's important that in the mission next to the strategic aspect also the cultural background is mentioned. This is because the employees need to know and support the mission to be able to carry it out effectively. The Ashbridge mission model offers guidance when drafting a mission by means of the following four elements (Ashridge-model, 2019):

Purpose:

The purpose of the company is the reason it exists. This needs to enable all employees to understand what the company is trying to achieve. Besides generating value for the shareholders, it also connects to the concept of your vision statement (Guide to the Ashridge Mission Model, n.d.). Beex believes that the most successful brand stories are created together. By using positive branding and communication strategies they set up meaningful connections between brands and consumers (Personal communication client, 2022).

Strategy:

The strategy is the way the company is going to get from A to B. It defines how the company can beat the competition and lays out the pathway to growth and success. Having a good strategy is vital because it provides a way to ensure everyone is on the same page (Guide to the Ashridge Mission Model, n.d.). Beex works with different packages that its clients can subscribe to. The client can choose different packages based on the number of hours they want. The packages are marketing support in the field of social media, design, PR, and influencers (Personal communication client, 2022).

Values:

Company values underpin the behaviors and beliefs that are implanted into a company's culture. Successful companies have a strong relationship and similarity between the company values and the personal values of each employee (Guide to the Ashridge Mission Model, n.d.). Beex their main values are creativity, flexibility, positivity, and energy. And this is also what they expect from their employees (Personal communication client, 2022).

Behavioral standards:

Behavioral standards or norms are the real-world implementations of your values. They can take many forms, from high-level concepts such as having a positive attitude when dealing with customers to being more specific about the process followed when certain activities are requested by customers (Guide to the Ashridge Mission Model, n.d.). The behavioral standards from Beex are that they work with a team of 9 creative women. And they believe that you can use creativity (in all its forms) to make the world a little more beautiful (Personal communication client, 2022).

Appendix 2

McKinsey 7's model

The McKinsey 7S model is a tool that analyzes a firm's organizational design by looking at 7 key internal elements. The elements the model focuses on are strategy, structure, systems, skills, style, staff, and shared values. With the model, you can identify if companies are effectively aligned and allow the organization to achieve its objectives (Jurevicius, 2022).

Strategy

Beex uses positive branding and communication strategies to shape a project. Something that was taught to them by their experience is that truly successful brand stories are created in collaboration. Which is how they make the most beautiful things not only with their fantastic group of creative people but also with the expertise of their customers (Over Beex, 2022). Beex is a boutique agency and not dreaming to become the biggest. (Client brief, 2022) For them, no project is the same which is why they offer every customer customization. This way all customers are assured that their projects are unique and personal.

Structure

Beex is a full-service marketing and PR agency. This means you can hire them to take care of your social media, public relations, branding and design, content, and digital marketing. They focus 80% on the BTC (Business To Customer) market and 20% on the BTB (Business To Business) market. Beex consists of a team of nine women who are all specialized in different areas like design & brand strategy and media & content (Client brief, 2022). Each member of the Beex team has their own contact at the brands they work for. They meet with them on a weekly, bi-weekly, or monthly basis (Personal communication client, 2022).

Systems

Besides helping with single things like shoots or design & branding. Beex also offers different packages to their clients. These packages are monthly subscriptions and are marketing support in the field of social media, design, PR, and influencers (Client brief, 2022).

Skills

Beex works with a young creative team with only women. Each Beex employee is specialized in a certain area and has their role. Combining all of these makes Beex the strong company they are. Beex takes care of the company's social media, public relations, branding and design, content, and digital marketing.

Style

Beex is a Boutique agency and is working with a team of only young, creative women. What makes them unique is that they work with a personal approach for each customer, to make them feel comfortable. Beex described in 3 words according to the CEO is creative, energetic, and flexible. They mostly focus on lifestyle, fashion, and food. The perfect Beex employee needs to be (and think) creative, flexible, positive, and energetic. Be strong in communication within the team and towards our clients (Personal communication client, 2022).

Staff

The Beex staff consists of the following roles:

- Founder
- Head of design & brand strategy
- Junior Creative
- Design intern
- Head of media & content

- Social media, content & PR managers
- Media, content & PR intern
- + Freelancers + other agencies photographers, videographers, copywriters, online marketers, UX designers, web developers, etc (Onze Creatievelingen, 2022).

Shared values

Beex believes that you can use creativity (in all its forms) to make the world a little more beautiful. They want to achieve this by building a team & working with clients with which their vision resonates (Personal communication client, 2022). What Beex finds very important is to work with a personal approach to each customer, as they want to make them feel comfortable and want to make each project unique and personal (Over Beex, 2022).

Appendix 3**Hofstede model**

The Hofstede model was developed by Geert Hofstede in 1980. The model is a framework used to understand the differences in culture across countries and to discern the ways that business is done across different cultures. According to Hofstede, six categories define culture (Corporate Finance Institute, 2022).

Power Distance

This dimension deals with the fact that all individuals in societies are not equal. It considers to which extent inequality and power are tolerated (Hofstede Insights, 2017).

Individualism vs collectivism

This refers to the strength of the mutual ties between individuals in a particular community. The high score which is individualism indicates that there is a greater place on attaining personal goals. The low score the collectivism indicates that there is a greater importance placed on the goals and well-being of the group (Corporate Finance Institute, 2022).

Masculinity vs femininity

A high score in this dimension which is the masculine indicates that the society will be driven by competition, achievement, and success. Wherever a low score which is the feminine means that the dominant values in society are caring for others and quality of life. A Feminine society is one where quality of life is the sign of success and standing out from the crowd is not admirable (Hofstede Insights, 2017).

Uncertainty avoidance

The uncertainty avoidance index considers the extent to which uncertainty and ambiguity are tolerated. This dimension considers how unknown situations and unexpected events are dealt with (Corporate Finance Institute, 2022).

Long term orientation vs. short term orientation

This dimension focuses on social values that are based on traditions and age-old values. The long-term orientation shows focus on the future and involves delaying short-term success or gratification in order to achieve long-term success. shows focus on the future and involves delaying short-term success or gratification in order to achieve long-term success (Corporate Finance Institute, 2022).

Indulgence vs. Restraint

The indulgence vs. restraint dimension considers the extent and tendency for a society to fulfill its desires (Corporate Finance Institute, 2022).

Appendix 4

Marketing Mix - 5P's Model Explanation

To analyse the internal structure and Beex's marketing strategy, a marketing mix has been drawn up. "Marketing mix is not a scientific theory, but merely a conceptual framework that identifies the principal decision making managers make in configuring their offerings to suit consumers' needs. The tools can be used to develop both long-term strategies and short-term tactical programmes" (Palmer, 2004). One way to do this is using the 4P's model, that was defined by Borden (1965) and then later updated by Judd (1987) by adding a fifth P. The 5 P's used for this marketing mix now stand for: Product, Price, Promotion, Place, People (Corporate Finance Institute, 2022).

Product describes the items and services that a company provides. Decisions about products are made based on factors including quality, warranty, function, and packaging (Corporate Finance Institute, 2022)..

Price relates to a product's or service's price strategy and how it will impact customers. Discounts, payment plans, credit conditions, and any available data concerning the prices they take for their product are all taken into consideration (Corporate Finance Institute, 2022)..

Promotion describes the actions used to increase customer awareness of the company. It consists of things like public relations, advertising, and sponsorships (Corporate Finance Institute, 2022). .

Place is the location of a business or its product and place of manufacture, sale, or distribution. Meaning, location choices have an impact on how a product is distributed and how to reach certain target clients (Corporate Finance Institute, 2022). .

People relates to the employees, and people who work for the company. It's all about knowing how you want your staff and company to be seen by your clients and target group (Corporate Finance Institute, 2022).

BEEX'S Marketing Mix (in accordance to 2.1.2 Marketing Mix)

Product = As a full-service agency, Beex focuses on providing its clients with multiple different services ranging from social media management and public relations to branding design and digital marketing. Their clients come to them with specific wishes and projects wanting to either build a new brand or simply needing external help with certain tasks or projects, that can be more or less time-consuming and require either one or multiple different departments' attention (Client Brief, 2022).

Some of Beex's special advantages as a full-service agency include the benefit of working with monthly, hour-based subscriptions of their services as well as project-limited cooperations. This gives the clients a sense of flexibility that can be very beneficial in today's ever-changing times (BEEX, n.d.-b). Another unique feature of Beex's services is the small, young, and creative team and boutique agency feeling without missing out on specialists. Although they are a relatively small team with nine members, excluding their partner advertising company, the client can still expect specialist work in all of their services and on top benefits from the intimate, down-to-earth, and accessible team (Client Brief, 2022).

Price = Their pricing ranges depending on the number of hours that the clients need. The current hourly rate lies at 85 euros per hour, although this can fluctuate depending on the different

“packages” one chooses and can also get cheaper the more hours are booked (Client Brief, 2022). Generally, there are three packages to choose from that start at 10h a month and end at 40h a month (BEEEX, n.d.-b). The packages are especially useful because they work with multiple different clients at once, and all need a different amount of attention. Therefore Beex offers modern-day flexibility perfectly fitted to their client's needs (Client Brief, 2022).

Promotion = Currently, most of Beex’s clients have approached them through their own network, showing no need for a specific promotion. Still, they have an online presence through their website, Instagram and LinkedIn, which they use to show current partnerships and post samples of their past projects and portfolio of brands they have worked with prior. Other than this they are not taking any further actions in terms of promoting their business, but mainly focus on working for and promoting their client's projects (Client Brief, 2022).

Place = As a Dutch agency, Beex is based in Amsterdam, NL. As a result, they are working with lots of dutch clients, with exceptions such as certain brands from abroad. Adding to this, they execute certain projects such as photoshoots abroad. Therefore, their work is mostly made in their office in Amsterdam but gets distributed to clients all over the EU and is therefore also seen in those countries. As for channels, their work can be seen anywhere from their designed packaging in supermarkets to menu cards, websites, social media accounts, product pictures online, etc. Their work is extremely diverse and ranges from the lifestyle industry to food or fashion (Client Brief, 2022).

People = At Beex, nine people make up the team, starting with founder and CEO Bieke van Orten, and continuing with Amber van Bussel (head of design and brand strategy), Jacky Vroomen (social media, content, and pr manager), Lotte van Baalen (social media, content and pr manager), Naomi Bernardus (social media, content and pr manager), Marith Veldhuizen (junior creative and social designer), Floor Beenhakker (trainee social media and pr), Maartje Wisseborn (trainee branding and design), Marije Jansen (trainee social content) and finally as the 10th person that is not an official part of the team but a partner, Thijs Verhoeven (partner web and online marketing) (BEEEX, n.d.-a).

They make up a young and creative, friendly team that is approachable and loves what they’re doing.

Appendix 5

UN Goals of sustainable development

The 17 UN goals of sustainable development are common goals set by all of the United Nation members in 2015. They entail 17 different calls to action ranging from “No Poverty” to “Climate Action” (THE 17 GOALS | Sustainable Development, n.d.). For the CSR analysis, some these goals have been used to identify possible ways Beex could start incorporating CSR into their marketing.



(THE 17 GOALS | Sustainable Development, n.d.)

How Beex can work on CSR

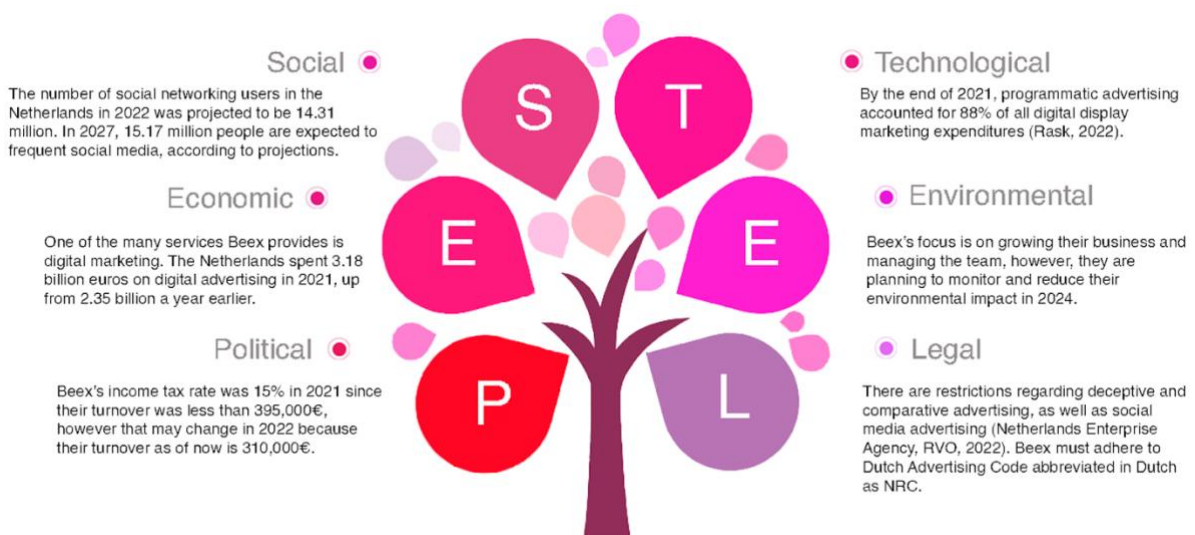
Starting from within the company and its people, CSR does not just include doing good for the planet but also working on good health and well-being of the employees and overall team dynamics. This could be done by officially promoting and establishing (eg. on websites or socials) self care and a healthy working environment with great hours, benefits, and a positive and supportive overall team mindset.

Other actions that could be taken are extra training to ensure quality education in the company and are able to offer the best service possible to the clients, or spreading awareness of gender equality through their website and socials. Especially since they are an all-women team, focusing and promoting women's rights and gender equality in the industry could really separate them from other agencies while making a positive impact in the industry.

Finally, responsible consumption and production is something that has to be thought of when it comes to a CSR campaign and fulfilling the planet part of the 3P Model (Mixon, 2021). Like any other business, Beex will have a negative impact on the planet which can be offset by using clean energy sources and possibly partnering up with sustainable brands or nonprofits that are dedicated to saving the planet.

Appendix 6

BEEEX - Macro Environment In-depth





Political

Legal entities in the Netherlands, such as a private limited company (bv) or a public limited company (nv), must always file a corporate income tax report. Private individuals, such as sole proprietors, pay income tax on their profits (inkomstenbelasting). Foundations and organizations are only required to submit corporate tax returns under certain instances. They may be excluded from corporate income tax depending on the level of profit (Netherlands Enterprise Agency, RVO, 2022).

Corporate Taxation

In 2022 BEEEX became a Limited liability company (BV) (Personal communication client, 2022). According to the Ministry of General Affairs or in Dutch Ministerie van Algemene Zaken (2022), the corporate income tax rate is determined by the amount taxed. The taxable amount is equal to the taxable profit for the year minus any deductible losses. The company income tax rate is 15% if the taxable amount is € 395,000 or less. If the taxable amount exceeds € 395,000, the corporate income tax rate is € 59,250 plus 25,8% of the taxable amount.

In Beex's case, their income tax rate was 15% in 2021 since their turnover was less than 395,000€, however that may change in 2022 because their turnover as of now is 310,000€.



Economy

One of the many services Beex provides is digital marketing. The Netherlands spent 3.18 billion euros on digital advertising in 2021, up from 2.35 billion a year earlier (Statista, 2022). As for digital video advertising investment in the Netherlands was 525 million euros in 2020, up 18 percent from the previous year. To compare, non-video display ad expenditure climbed by about 4% (Statista, 2022).

Another service that Beex offers is Search Engine Optimization. As of today, search is the most popular format of digital advertising and it attracted investments totaling 1.52 billion euros (Statista, 2022).

As for social media ad spending, The Netherlands is anticipated to spend 1.65 billion euros on mobile social media advertising by 2026, up from 700 million euros in 2021 (Statista, 2022).

According to Statista (2022) On a European scale, out of all European markets, the United Kingdom (UK) was predicted to have the largest social media advertising revenue in 2022 with approximately 12 billion U.S. dollars in revenue, followed by Germany, France, Italy, and Spain respectively.



Social

Social media is one of Beex's fields of expertise, the number of social networking users in the Netherlands in 2022 was projected to be 14.31 million. In 2027, 15.17 million people are expected to frequent social media, according to projections. In the Netherlands, the number of social media users climbed by 14% between 2018 and 2022. (Statista, 2022).

When users were asked what social media platforms they use regularly, the results showed that Facebook, YouTube, Instagram, Pinterest, and LinkedIn respectively remain the most social networks used in The Netherlands in 2022 (Statista). TikTok, a popular social video app, was popular with Generation Z and Millennials but only had a 7% usage rate among Generation X (Statista, 2022).

According to data from Statista (2020), for Dutch Millennials, or 20 to 39-year-olds, WhatsApp, Facebook, and YouTube were named as the three most popular social media platforms in 2020. In 2020, YouTube fell behind Facebook and WhatsApp as the third-most-popular social media network among Dutch Gen Xers or 40 to 64-year-olds. As for Dutch Gen Z, WhatsApp, YouTube, Instagram, and Snapchat were the most popular social media platforms respectively.



Technological

By the end of 2021, programmatic advertising accounted for 88% of all digital display marketing expenditures (Rask, 2022). Instead of purchasing directly from publishers, programmatic advertising is a means to automatically acquire and optimize digital campaigns. It aims to replace human bargaining with AI optimization and machine learning. The intention is to boost efficiency and openness for both publishers and advertisers.

Other marketing technologies trends in 2022 (Muzyka) include wearable tech integration, VR/AR content, Chatbots, Push notifications and Internet of Things marketing.



Legal

Employment Laws

Businesses in the Netherlands can offer employees fixed-term or permanent employment contracts. Beex cannot endlessly prolong temporary contracts. After three consecutive temporary contracts or three years of temporary contracts, an employee must be given a permanent contract (Netherlands Enterprise Agency, RVO, 2022). The employment contract must include various information such as on employee's nature of work, arrangements for working overtime, holiday allowance, and entitlement, among other essential information (Netherlands Enterprise Agency, RVO, 2022).

Advertisement Laws

Advertising is governed by rules in the Netherlands. For example, there are restrictions regarding deceptive and comparative advertising, as well as social media advertising (Netherlands Enterprise Agency, RVO, 2022). Beex must adhere to Dutch Advertising Code abbreviated in Dutch as NRC. This

applies to all forms of advertising, regardless of the medium used. The NRC defines broad advertising regulations as well as customized advertising guidelines for specific products and services.



Environmental

According to communication with Beex (2022), as of today, Beex's focus is on growing their business and managing the team, however, they are planning to monitor and reduce their environmental impact in 2024.

About the PESTLE Model

P	E	S	T	E	L
- Government policy - Political stability - Corruption - Foreign trade policy - Tax policy - Labour law - Trade restrictions	- Economic growth - Exchange rates - Interest rates - Inflation rates - Disposable income - Unemployment rates	- Population growth rate - Age distribution - Career attitudes - Safety emphasis - Health consciousness - Lifestyle attitudes - Cultural barriers	- Technology incentives - Level of innovation - Automation - R&D activity - Technological change - Technological awareness	- Weather - Climate - Environmental policies - Climate change - Pressures from NGO's	- Discrimination laws - Antitrust laws - Employment laws - Consumer protection laws - Copyright and patent laws - Health and safety laws



According to Barrington (2021) a writer in the Oxford College of Marketing blog, the acronym PESTLE stands for a method for determining the macro (external) forces that are influencing a company. The

letters are PESTLE, which stand for Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Environmental, and Legal. Below is an explanation of every factor (Barrington, 2021).

Political Factors

These determine the potential influence of the government and government policies on a company or an industry. In addition to trade, economic, and taxation policies, this would also involve political stability and policy.

Economic Factors

An economic component has an immediate influence on the economy and its performance, which in turn has an immediate impact on the organization and its profitability. Interest rates, employment or unemployment rates, raw material costs, and foreign currency rates are all factors.

Social Factors

The social environment and recognizing new trends are the main points of emphasis here. Because of this, a marketer is better able to comprehend the requirements and desires of consumers in social settings. Factors include shifting family demographics, educational attainment, cultural developments, attitudinal shifts, and lifestyle changes.

Technological Factors

The rate of technical innovation and development that could have an impact on a market or sector is one of the technological aspects. Changes in digital or mobile technologies, automation, and research and development may all be factors. It is common to merely pay attention to technological advancements in the digital realm, but distribution, manufacturing, and logistical innovations must also be taken into account.

Environmental Factors

Environmental variables are those that are impacted by ecological factors and the environment around them. This component is becoming increasingly crucial to how businesses should operate as CSR (Corporate Sustainability Responsibility) and sustainability become more and more important. Climate, recycling practices, carbon footprint, garbage disposal, and sustainability are all factors.

Legal Factors

An organization has to be aware of the rules and regulations of the countries where it conducts business. They also need to be informed of any changes in the law and how they can affect how their firm is run. Employment law, consumer law, health and safety laws, international trade regulations, and other factors are among them.

Political and legal elements might overlap, but the main distinction is that while legal considerations must be followed, political ones are guided by government policy.

Why use the PESTLE model?

The PESTLE elements are often beyond of an organization's control therefore, it is essential to analyze them as they may have significant influence on an organization's strategic alternatives and market position. PESTLE analysis serves ideally as the foundation for the SWOT analysis as it identifies key drivers of change that have an impact on an organization and industry. It helps understanding the trends and factors that are out of an organization's control and then leading to the internal elements that are more likely to be under their control for instance the SWOT analysis (Mitchell & Britt, 2019).

Appendix 7

Competitors

Porter's Five Forces is a model that recognizes and evaluates five competitive forces that influence every industry and helps in determining the weaknesses and strengths of that industry. The Five Forces analysis is frequently used to establish business strategy by understanding the structure of a particular industry (Porter's 5 Forces Explained and How to Use the Model, 2022).

Competitor #1

DEBT is a global digital agency that was established in 1996. They provide cutting-edge technology and marketing to help brands stay ahead of the competition. The team consists of over 3,500 digital specialists spread across 30+ offices on five continents. They contribute to the creation of integrated end-to-end digital experiences on a global scale while maintaining a boutique culture. With the slogan "We live and breathe our 'big enough to cope, small enough to care,'" they are open to collaborating with any brand in the world (DEBT - Services, 2022).

They provide services in the following industries: Retail & Commerce, Fashion & Lifestyle, Energy & Utilities, Banks, Finance & Insurance, Travel & Leisure Industry, Consume Googs & Services, Manufacturing & Industry, Health & Life Science, Public Sector & Non-Profit, Technology, Media & Communication, Agriculture, and Food Industry (DEBT - Services, 2022).

Some of the biggest brands in the world are working with DEBT, like Google, KLM, Samsung, Apple, Netflix, Spotify, Tesla and so much more (DEBT - Services, 2022).

Competitor #2

Voxx is an Amsterdam-based marketing agency that was founded in 1997. Together with your sales, marketing, and/or communication teams, the Voxx Strategy team will develop an answer to all of these questions. Not so much because of the means as it is because of the content. Based on this, they develop your value proposition, core message, and content strategy (Strategy - Voxx Content in Context -, 2022).

Their services include market positioning, content strategy, and campaigns. They collaborate with companies such as T-Service, Rijksoverheid, Airborne, Strebrug, and others (Strategy - Voxx Content in Context -, 2022).

Geographic:

Beex is located in the Netherlands which means that most of the clients are Dutch but Beex also has a big international clientele like Italy, the USA, Australia, etc (Beex, n.d.).

Demographic:

Most lifestyle business owners are women which were proven by a recent UENI report: "Women account for 45% of all small business owners. Furthermore, women make up 52% of sole proprietors." (Women Entrepreneurs Making Progress, but Gender Gaps Remain, 2020).

In terms of age, the average age of entrepreneurs in the Netherlands is around 46 years old and has remained stable for many years. However, the average age of new entrepreneurs fell slightly in 2019 to 35 years (NL Times, 2020).

Psychographic & Behavioral:

In the context of communication, business-to-business refers to methods of connecting employees from different companies, such as social media. B2B (or B-to-B) communication refers to communication

between employees of two or more companies (Business-to-Business (B2B): What It Is and How It's Used, 2020).

To be successful, business-to-business transactions must be planned. Such transactions rely on account management personnel at a company to establish business client relationships. For successful transactions to occur, business-to-business relationships must also be nurtured, typically through professional interactions prior to sales (Business-to-Business (B2B): What It Is and How It's Used, 2020).

USP model

A unique selling point (USP) is a distinguishing feature of a product or service in contrast to other goods or services. It is a distinct advantage that makes goods or services more appealing and valuable. This allows a product or service to stand out from the crowd. In marketing, a Unique Selling Point is used to persuade a customer to purchase a product or service. A unique selling point (USP) can be anything, such as a unique service or a unique quality feature (Eelants, 2020).

Appendix 8

Financial core data

Turnover, costs and profit

	2021		2020	
	€	%	€	%
Netto-omzet	334.099	100,0%	236.007	100,0%
Inkoopwaarde van de omzet	51.221	15,3%	31.910	13,5%
Bruto bedrijfsresultaat	282.878	84,7%	204.097	86,5%
Lonen en salarissen	125.573	37,6%	56.567	24,0%
Sociale lasten	23.567	7,1%	10.497	4,5%
Afschrijvingen materiële vaste activa	1.742	0,5%	513	0,2%
Overige personeelskosten	-807	-0,2%	-440	-0,2%
Huisvestingskosten	18.805	5,6%	11.620	4,9%
Verkoopkosten	15.725	4,7%	1.319	0,6%
Autokosten	29	0,0%	-	0,0%
Kantoorkosten	6.785	2,0%	7.657	3,2%
Algemene kosten	5.662	1,7%	5.919	2,5%
Som der kosten	197.081	59,0%	93.652	39,7%
Bedrijfsresultaat	85.797	25,7%	110.445	46,8%
Rentelasten en soortgelijke kosten	-374	-0,1%	-368	-0,2%
Som der financiële baten en lasten	-374	-0,1%	-368	-0,2%
Resultaat	85.423	25,6%	110.077	46,6%

Influences higher profit in 2020 than 2021

1.3 Resultaatvergelijking

Het resultaat 2021 is ten opzichte van 2020 gedaald met € 24.654. De ontwikkeling van het resultaat 2021 ten opzichte van 2020 kan als volgt worden weergegeven:

	€	€
Het resultaat is gunstig beïnvloed door:		
<i>Stijging van:</i>		
Omzet	98.092	
<i>Daling van:</i>		
Overige personeelskosten	367	
Kantoorkosten	872	
Algemene kosten	257	
		99.588
Het resultaat is ongunstig beïnvloed door:		
<i>Stijging van:</i>		
Inkoopwaarde van de omzet	19.311	
Lonen en salarissen	69.006	
Sociale lasten	13.070	
Afschrijvingen materiële vaste activa	1.229	
Huisvestingskosten	7.185	
Verkoopkosten	14.406	
Autokosten	29	
Rentelasten en soortgelijke kosten	6	
		124.242
Daling resultaat		24.654

Appendix 9

SWOT analysis

More information on each SWOT analysis component is provided in this section.

S.

Strengths

Starting with strengths, Beex is a so called “full-service agency”. This means that they have different kinds of services they can provide and therefore make Beex attractive for customers that otherwise would have to hire multiple different agencies to get a project done (see 2.1.1). In accordance with this, they also provide package deals with different amounts of monthly hours which gives clients the benefit of **flexibility** in today fast paced time, adapting to client's needs and letting the clients switch to more or fewer hours of assistance with their projects (see 2.1.2). Adding to this, Beex is a **small “boutique”, creative and young, women-only team.** All these attributes are strengths that let clients have an **intimate, personalized, accepting, and fun work environment** while receiving **high-quality results** (see 2.1.2 & 2.1.3). Their work and clients are also very **diverse**, ranging from lifestyle companies to restaurants or fashion brands (see 2.1.2). With this being the case, it is a great advantage that Beex has such a **wide variety of knowledge and experience** from their team members for the clients since it is necessary to accommodate the customers and therefore sustain a suitable product-market-combination (see 2.1.3). In Beex’s case, the internal analysis shows that they have a **good product-market-combination** since they are based on open dialogue and consumer trust

while offering unique services to a certain clientele, indicating that the brand's focus is on lifestyle, cuisine, and fashion (see 2.1.3). Finally, one of Beex's areas of expertise is social media. **Social Media** is a field that is still consistently **growing** according to the PESTLE analysis results and therefore provides a relatively safe future for their social media project-based clients (see 2.2.1)

Weaknesses

W.

Regardless, the analysis also brought up some potential weaknesses, including the **missing CSR** components. As mentioned in the internal analysis (see 2.1.6) including Cooperate Social Responsibility into companies marketing and mission/vision, can be the deciding factor for future clients choosing Beex over their competitors. It also strengthens the company overall by adding more value to their work through satisfying not only their own profit but also making a positive impact on people and the planet (see 2.1.6). Another small but still mentionable weakness could pose the participative **management style**. By making all the team members part of the decision process, especially since they are a small team, some personalities could eventually end up wanting to have more ruling power and therefore start commanding other team members which could lead to friction within the Beex team (see 2.1.1). An additional weakness was found in Beex's missing marketing for their business. They only connect with clients over their network but do not take any further actions to directly promote the agency (see 2.1.2). By doing this they could miss out on potential clients that simply aren't in their network. Finally, as seen in 2.1.4 Legal aspects, Beex has little to no legal protection when it comes to trademarks for eg. their brand name & logo, licenses, NDA's with business partners, the GDPR, their IP, or being registered at the Benelux office of IP. This could become more and more dangerous as the company grows bigger and could potentially create issues in the future.

Opportunities

O.

Beex indicated that it is currently not involved in any corporate social responsibility initiatives (Client brief, 2022). This is one of the company's weaknesses. It is critical that Beex begins working on its CSR efforts. This would be a great opportunity to take advantage of because it is becoming increasingly important for firms to prioritize CSR as it may assist in staff recruitment and retention, improve how customers perceive Beex as a brand, and demonstrate investor accountability (Heyward, 2020). Beex is busy promoting the projects of their clients, as described in 2.1.2 Marketing Mix but they are doing little to further market their own business. Therefore, another opportunity that Beex has is to better market its company. The main benefit of a promotion is that it helps a company stand out from its competitors, additionally, it allows Beex to create and maintain its reputation as a brand, increases sales, and stays relevant to its customers and industry (Jaiswal, 2022).

As stated in 2.1.2 Marketing Mix, Beex now works with a large number of Dutch clients; thus, working with more clients abroad would be an opportunity for Beex to take advantage of in order to expand its international prospects and possible future collaborations. Additionally, through this, the business would be able to expand its networks and connections abroad in case they ever decide to export its services elsewhere.

Beex is a creative firm, and one of its fundamental values is creativity as mentioned in 1.3 Mission & Vision. The company works with many different forms of design, whether for social media or other types of activities, thus one opportunity they have would be to sell NFTs on their website. A non-fungible token (NFT) is a blockchain-stored encrypted smart contract and they are most frequently utilized in graphic design and digital art (Link, 2021). “With sales increasing every year by several factors. All types of creators, from businesses to artists, are looking to get involved, with thousands of new NFT collections created every day.” (Certhis, 2022). Alongside the services they currently offer, this would be an additional source of revenue for the business.

Threats

T.

As mentioned in 2.2.2 Competition, DEPT and VOXX are the two main competitors for Beex. According to Sally Hogshead (n.d.), a New York Times bestselling author “Competition threatens your ability to stand out and win.”. As a result, Beex must be aware of this threat to their business and seize on the various opportunities available to them in order to stand out and excel.

A firm may be at threat from technological changes due to automation and increased competition, it is, therefore, crucial to keep up with significant technological advancements in the industry and have sufficient flexibility in workflows to swiftly adapt (Indeed Editorial Team, 2021). In 2.2.1 Macro Environment in the technology component in the PESTEL model, numerous technological trends are described, Beex might be at threat if they do not stay on top of technological advancements.

In 2.2.1 Macro Environment, it is stated that businesses in the Netherlands pay corporate income tax depending on the level of profit, the amount of taxes that Beex has to pay in 2022 may be increased due to their increased revenue in comparison with 2021 which may pose a threat to Beex as increased taxes are a financial and administrative burden for small businesses, which has a direct influence on their capacity to invest in their organization (Dunkelberg, 2021).

According to 2.1.4 Legal Aspects, BEEEX is not a registered trademark. According to Alex Bajjon (2018), a European patent and trademark attorney, it is possible that a third party will register the same or a similar trademark, which will then be used to prevent Beex from using their trademark even if they were the first to use it. This is another threat to Beex that they should be aware of.

Appendix 10

Conclusion

In relation to the objective of the research and central research question and sub-questions (page 4), the current internal and external analysis of the organization and its market position is described in Internal Analysis 2.1 (page 5 - 13) and External Analysis 2.2 (page 13 - 15). As for the sub-questions, every sub-question has been answered throughout every chapter of the report. Each research sub-question is included in the table below along with the chapter where it has been addressed.

Sub-question	Chapter
What are BEEEX's mission and vision, in accordance with the Ashbridge model, in the year 2022?	1.3 Mission and Vision (page 5)
How is BEEEX's business organized, including people, resources, and structure in the year 2022?	2.1.1 Internal Analysis: People, resources, structure (page 6)
What is BEEEX's marketing strategy, in accordance with the 5P's model, in 2022?	2.1.2 The marketing mix (page 8)
What is BEEEX's Product Market Combination, in accordance with the STP model in the year 2022?	2.1.3 PMC (page 9)
What are BEEEX's legal aspects based on the legal rights in The Netherlands in the year 2022?	2.1.4 Legal aspects (page 10)
What is BEEEX's financial core data, including profit development, turnover development, and cost development from 2021 to 2022?	2.1.5 Financial core data (page 12)
What entails BEEEX's CSR strategy, in accordance with the 3P Model and the 17 sustainability goals of the UN, in the year 2022?	2.1.6 Corporate social responsibility (page 12)

Where is Beex's position concerning external environmental impacts on the company, including their macro environment and competition, in accordance with the PESTLE analysis and Porter's 5 forces model, in the year 2022?	2.2.1 Macro environment (page 13) 2.2.2 Competition (page 14)
What defines BEEEX's target group, using the four types of segmentation, including demographic, psychographic, geographic, and behavioral properties, in the year 2022?	2.2.3 Target group (page 14)

Appendix 11

PMC

A product market combination (PMC), according to Almora (2021), "is a unique combination of products for a specific group of customers" (Almora, 2021). According to Camman (2018), "every company provides a set of services or products. These products can meet different needs of different types of customers" (Camman, 2018). In this case, BEEEX offers a variety of services including social media management, public relations, brand design, digital marketing, and content creation (Client Brief, 2022). It is essential to be able to meet the needs of customers in order to provide a good product-market combination. A model known as Kotler's STP model can be used to determine whether the customer's needs have been met. This model will determine whether BEEEX provides a good product market combination in three steps, the first being segmentation, the second targeting, and the third positioning.

Segmentation refers to the communication surrounding a business, specifically the message and image that will help the company differentiate itself from the competition. For that, "various segmentation criteria can be used to divide up the market, including demographic, geographic, psychographic, and behavioral variables" (Claessens, 2016). As a result, it is critical to understand who will be targeted. In terms of location, the agency BEEEX is based in the Netherlands, specifically in Amsterdam. As a result, it is important for them to focus on nearby brands even though they retain customers from abroad, such as in England, because they have a partner agency in London. In terms of demographic, behavioral, and psychographic aspects, BEEEX is targeting lifestyle, food, and even fashion companies, implying that they keep a wide range of options for their clients. As can be seen on their website, multiple brands offer products from all over the world, but the focus remains on Europe. To be specific, BEEEX is not focusing on choosing their customers on the demographic, behavioral, and psychographic aspects. However, BEEEX stays a very measurable, accessible, substantial, and actionable company (Claessens, 2016).

As a result, for the targeting part, which entails targeting a specific segment, it would be appropriate to target the geographic segment, as it appears to be the most important for the company (Claessens, 2015).

Finally, as mentioned in Claessens' (2015) article, brand positioning is critical. It determines the image that a customer may have in order to purchase a product or service. According to Claessens (2015), the value proposition, or full positioning of a brand, is the "full mix of benefits on which the product or brand is positioned" (Claessens, 2015). As a result, it is critical to understand which benefits BEEEX would be positioned on in order to capture the customer's attention. As previously stated, BEEEX is a small company with only nine employees, all of whom are women. They place a high value on keeping the company small in order to stay close to one another and maintain a trusting relationship within the team. As a result, it is possible to position this company on the advantages of being small, such as being close to and connected to their clients and paying close attention to their needs.

Appendix 12

Legal aspects

Form: BEEEX has become a private limited company headquartered in Amsterdam. The company started as a sole proprietorship but transitioned to a BV as the turnover increased and it seemed more advantageous for them to become a private limited company. They also increased their staff, client's market importance, resulting in a larger media purchase. Switching to a private limited company was the solution to prevent those changes from introducing additional risks, but it also made it more interesting in terms of taxes. BEEEX is in charge of sales tax, corporation tax, and payroll tax (Personal communication client, 2022). According to the article Netherlands Chamber of Commerce, KVK (2022), a private limited company, in the Netherlands more specifically, **is run** by one director or multiple. In this case, **only** Bieke van Orten is the founder and director of BEEEX.

Trademark: According to Unregistered Trademarks (2021), not having registered a company's trademark leads the company legal rights only within the geographic areas in which it operates. BEEEX is not a registered trademark. As stated by the BEEEX company, they do not place much value on the name BEEEX because several companies are already known by that name.

Licenses: According to the company information shared with us, BEEEX has a lease subletting **their office building** from another party. They also state that they do not have an environmental permit. **However**, permits are required when starting a business. Each business requires a different type of license, but they all require at least "a business license, a trading license, and a sales tax permit" (Writer, n.d.). **Although, while communicating with BEEEX, there has been no mention of any kind of licenses.**

NDA: A non-disclosure agreement is a "contract that is legally binding and establishes a confidential relationship" (Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) Explained, With Pros & Cons, 2022). As a result, it means protecting the data that has been shared, which is essential. However, BEEEX confirmed that they are not actively involved in dealing with agreements between them and third parties because they mostly work in good faith with those parties.

GDPR: According to How to Make Your Business GDPR Compliant (2022), the GDPR controls the processing of personal data. It is an EU regulation that allows businesses to be more careful with the personal data of their employees, customers, and others.

Since BEEEX processes personal data of e.g., their employees or clients, they have to adhere to the General Data Protection Regulation like any other business. Still, through communication with BEEEX, they have not expressed how they take actions to do so.

IP: Intellectual property is defined as a "collective term for rights that protect the realizations of ideas and concepts" (Netherlands Enterprise Agency RVO, 2022). As a result, IP is important to take into account, particularly in a company like BEEEX, which uses designs. Nevertheless, the company confirmed that their intellectual property is not officially protected, but they can still revoke the IP rights if third parties begin working with it, as article 14 of their terms and conditions addresses copyright and intellectual property: "Copyright and any other (intellectual) property rights to the Services produced by Beex Branding are vested solely in Beex Branding, regardless of the revision of the Service on Client's instructions." (BEEEX, n.d.-b). Additionally, all of the BEEEX company's rights in relation to the customer designs are listed in this article. For example, it states that BEEEX has the right to use any designs developed for its own publicity or promotion and that a client cannot alter the execution of a design.

Contracting: As it embodies the agreements between two or more parties and establishes the rights and obligations of each, contracting is a crucial component (Legal Contracts: What Are They? Types? How They Work (2022), n.d.). The sort of employee contract has not been stated in communications with the company BEEEX. Although they also make their terms and conditions available on their website, they manage deals mostly via emailing a quote and their terms and conditions. Regarding the employees, it has been mentioned that their contract covers a wide range of risks.

Appendix 13:**Rewrite Improvement Log**

Page	Item	Element criticized by the examiners according to assessment form	Action taken by the student
		Too many pages	Reduced number of pages
3	Research Question	Marked satisfactory	Added in substantiations and sources
7	Legal form and intellectual property	'... in Writer (n.d.)...' multiple times?? 'According to the article Netherlands Chamber of Commerce, KVK (2022), a private limited company, in the Netherlands more specifically, by only one director or multiple.' meaning?? Part on licenses is not clear. I miss a part on contracting (employee's, third parties, zzp). GDPR: they process personal data (employees, zzp). art 14 of the terms and conditions; what does it say?? Important in this case, as it protects their IP	Made the appropriate changes according to the elements criticized by the examiners in the assessment form.
8	Profit, Turnover and Costs	• Turnover is incorrect. The amounts mentioned are Gross Profit. • No info about Sole Proprietorship and private withdrawals CEO.	Made the appropriate changes according to the elements criticized by the examiners in the assessment form.

		• In the appendix an unnecessary part about Corporate TAX, since that only applies to BV/NV's. • In the appendix a copy of a number of pages from the financial statements, without further explanation. • No financial information about the revenue model (hourly rates, etc.). • Also in the graph some amounts are not correct: • Turnover Private Company €156k? • €228k must be €282k. • Salary CEO via Holding? This paragraph could also use some repair and expansion.	
12 - 13	Conclusion problem statement and analysis	The way the questions are being answered is not clear. Just referring to chapters is not enough.	Added in a conclusion with link to Beex's SWOT analysis.